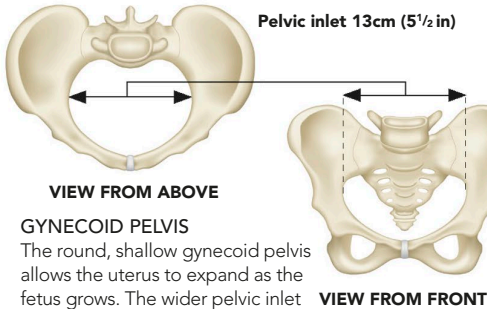


PELVIC SHAPES

A female's pelvis is adapted to child-bearing and delivery, but it varies greatly in shape. Some shapes make childbirth easier than others. The classic "female pelvis" (gynecoid)

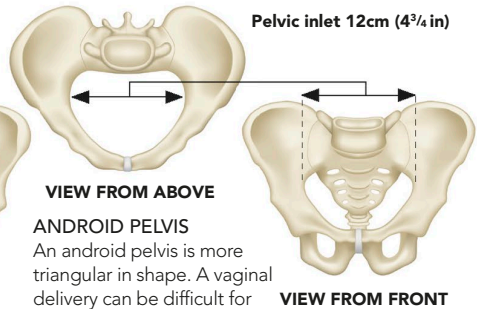
has a generous capacity, and usually results in few problems. A pelvis that is more like a man's (android) is less spacious and can cause difficulties with childbirth.



VIEW FROM ABOVE

GYNECOID PELVIS

The round, shallow gynecoid pelvis allows the uterus to expand as the fetus grows. The wider pelvic inlet provides more room for the head of a fetus to pass through.

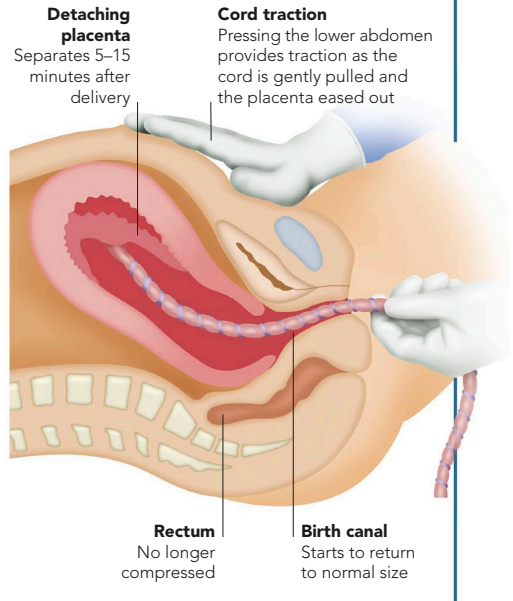
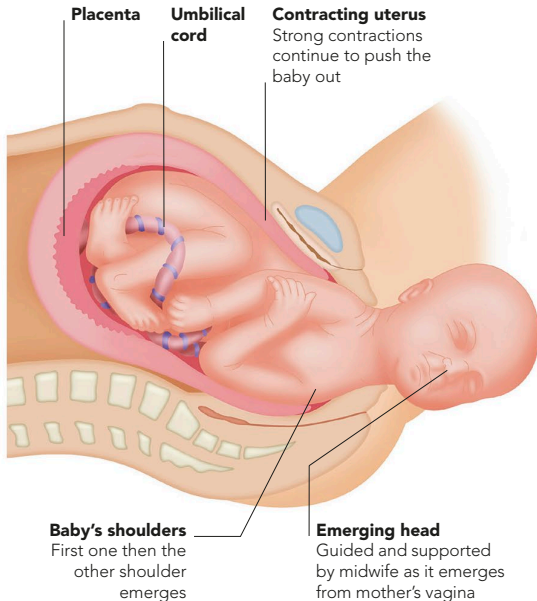


VIEW FROM ABOVE

ANDROID PELVIS

An android pelvis is more triangular in shape. A vaginal delivery can be difficult for a woman with an android pelvis unless her baby is small.

VIEW FROM FRONT



3 DELIVERY OF THE BABY

The midwife checks the cord is not around the baby's neck, and clears mucus from its nose and mouth. The baby rotates again so the shoulders can slip out easily, one shoulder quickly followed by the other.

4 DELIVERY OF THE PLACENTA

The uterus mildly contracts soon after the baby is born, sealing any bleeding blood vessels. The placenta separates from the uterus and is eased out by gently pulling the cord while pressing on the lower abdomen.